THE

# HANDSOME

# COBLER:

OR THE

## Father Outwitted.



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# THE HANDSOME COBLER.

YOU that delight in merriment,
come liſten to my ſong,
'Tis very new and certain true,
you will not tarry long
Before you laugh your belly full,
then be pleas'd to ſtay,
And I hope you will be pleaſed
before you go away.

There was a knight in Derbyſhire,
that had a handſome ſon,
He kept a handſome chambermaid,
the which his favour won:
They dearly lov'd each other,
and oft would ſport and play,
Until he got her belly up,
pray mind now what I ſay.

In tears ſhe told the ſtory,
my deareſt love ſaid ſhe,

I am not lefs than twenty weeks,
now gone with child to thee;
He faid love, be contented,
there's all that can be faid,
And do not let my father know,
next Sunday we'll be wed.
But mind how cruel fortune
their ruin ftrove to force,
The old man ftood in a corner,
and heard their whole difcourfe;
Next day he call'd the chambermaid,
likewife the youth his fon,
And with a fmiling leering look,
the tale he thus began.
And faid, I wifh you both much joy,
I hear you're to wed on Sunday,
But prithee now be rul'd by me,
and put it off till Monday:
It will be but one day longer,
with that he laugh'd outright;
But ah! faid he, I'll part you both,
for fear it be to-night.
He paid the girl her wages,
and home the girl was fent,
And he has him confined,
in tears for to lament;

Next morning away to London,
along with a ſturdy guide,
To his uncle's houſe in Cheapſide,
and there for to abide.
And as they rode along the road,
he ſaid unto the guide,
I'll give thee twenty guineas,
let me but ſtep aſide.
Becauſe this very morning,
one word my father ſaid,
The which I will remember,
and keep it in my head.
The guide he then did give conſent.
he went to his ſweet-heart Sue,
And told her the whole ſtory,
what he deſign'd to do.
Diſguis'd like an old cobler,
with ſham old muſty beard,
In leather coat, ſcarce worth a groat,
to his father's houſe he rode.
He knocked at the door right ha rd
his father thither came,
He ſaid, ſir, are you ſuch-a-one,
he anſwer'd, yes, I am.
He ſaid, I underſtand your ſon,
a wanton trick has play'd,

Unknown unto your worſhip,
and with a chambermaid.
I underſtand, ſome money, ſir,
with her you're free to give,
To help to keep the child and ſhe,
as long as they ſhall live:
And I'm an honeſt cobler,
and liveth here hard by,
For fifty pounds I'll marry her,
if that will ſatisfy.
The old man ſaid, before then
the money I do pay,
I'll ſee her fairly married,
and I'll give her away.
With all my heart, the cobler
unto the old man ſaid;
With that he fetch'd the 50 pounds,
the bargain it was made.
And when he came into the church,
as we do underſtand,
The old man ſtrutted boldly up,
and took her by the hand.
And cry'd out, heaven bleſs ye,
and ſend you long to live,
For as a token of my love,
theſe fifty pounds I give.

And ſo they parted friendly,
the old man home he went,
The bride and bridegroom rode away
to London with conſent;
Where ſhe was fairly brought to bed,
with joy and much content:
A letter to the country
he to his father ſent,
Sir, I think it is my duty,
that you acquainted be,
There's a lady in this city,
that's fallen in love with me;
Five hundred pounds a year ſhe's got
all in good houſe and land,
And if you're willing for the match,
come up, ſir, out of hand.
The old man got his coach, ſir,
and up to London came,
For to ſee this fair Lady
of noble birth and fame;
But, coming to his brother's houſe,
this beauty for to view,
He little thought this bonny bride,
had been his ſervant Sue.
With gold and ſilver ſpangles,
ſhe was dreſſed all around,

The noiſe of her portion ſpread,
of ſo many thouſand pounds;
The old man call'd his ſon aſide,
and thus to him did ſay,
Take my advice, and marry her,
dear child this very day.
That morning they were married,
and dinner being done,
The old man being mellow,
the ſtory thus began:
Says he, dear ſon, I'll tell to you,
nothing but what is true,
A poor blinking one-ey'd cobler,
has married your ſweet-heart Sue.
The young man ſlept aſide, ſir,
as I ſhall here confeſs,
And in a very little time,
put on the cobler's dreſs;
And taking Suſan by the hand,
he fell upon his knees;
Saying, pardon, honoured father,
ſir, pardon, if you pleaſe.
Sir, I am John the cobler,
and this is honeſt Sue,
Oh, pardon us, dear father,
becauſe I tell you true.

If thou be the cobler, ſaid the old man,
that had the blinking eye,
You've cobl'd me out of fifty pounds,
pox on your policy.

The uncle has perſuaded him,
and ſo did all the gueſts;
The old man fell a-laughing,
and cri'd, I do confeſs,
That I cannot be angry,
and ſtraight theſe words did ſay,
Come, do, call in the fidler,
and let's be merry to-day.

Thus we ſee the old and rich,
are bit by policy;
For beauty, wit, and manners,
beyond all riches be.
Then, drink a health to the cobler,
another to honeſt Sue,
See every one take off his glaſs
without any more ado.

FINIS.